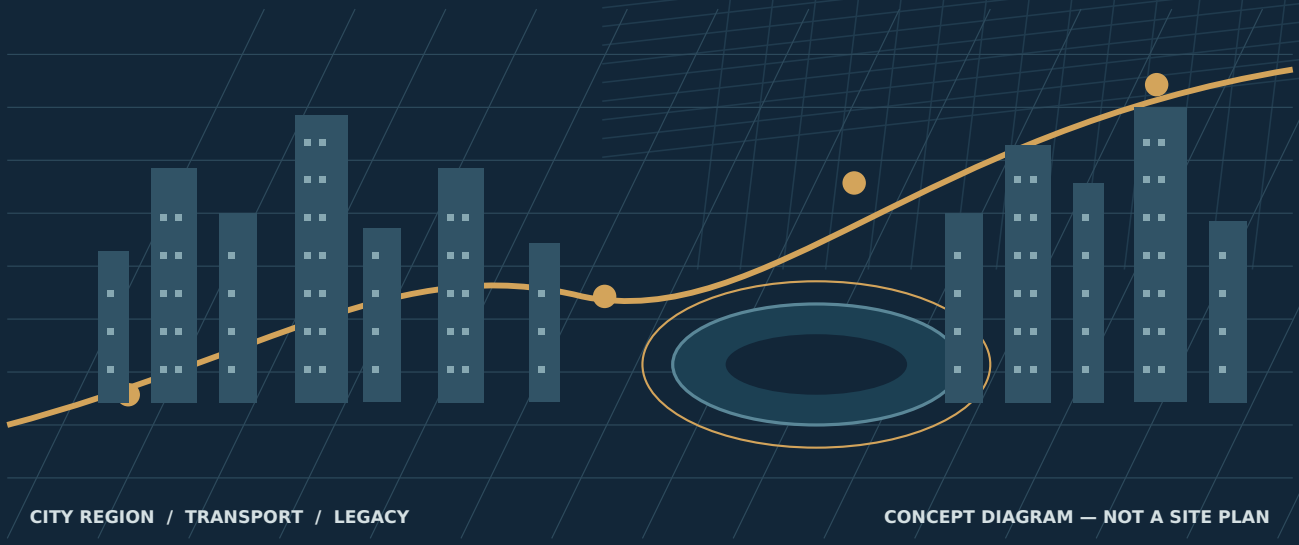
STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL / 2040s

MANCHESTER OLYMPICS 2040

A public-private compact for a Northern Games and the long-term transformation of Old Trafford



CITY REGION / TRANSPORT / LEGACY

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — NOT A SITE PLAN

PROPOSED PUBLIC PARTNER

UK Government, working with Greater Manchester and relevant public bodies

£25bn

Indicative public-side programme envelope

PROPOSED PRIVATE PARTNER

BTCPhilosopher Holdings

£25bn

Indicative private-side programme envelope

Prepared for discussion with HM Government, Greater Manchester partners and prospective delivery stakeholders. 25 October 2026.

STATUS: CONCEPT ONLY — no host decision, funding approval, land transfer, development right or government commitment is implied.

01 / THE PROPOSITION

A Games that builds a city-region

The proposal is to establish a matched £50bn long-term investment framework linking a Manchester-led Olympic and Paralympic ambition for 2040 with a carefully governed regeneration programme centred on Old Trafford. The Games are the catalyst; the lasting asset is a more connected, productive and liveable North.

£50bn	£25bn	2040
Illustrative total programme envelope	Indicative public + £25bn private	Target Games year, if awarded

The proposed compact

- UK Government and public partners: provide an indicative £25bn public-side programme envelope, subject to Treasury approval, statutory processes, value-for-money tests and staged funding decisions. Public exposure must be capped, disclosed and independently assessed.
- BTCPhilosopher Holdings: underwrite an indicative £25bn private-side investment programme through committed equity, project finance and institutional co-investment. Only binding, financeable commitments count toward the private contribution.
- Old Trafford: BTCPhilosopher Holdings competes for a time-limited, performance-based master-development concession over clearly defined parcels in an agreed Old Trafford regeneration zone, in return for its capital commitment and delivery obligations.
- Manchester and the North: adopt a reuse-first regional venue plan, coordinated with existing transport, sports and cultural assets, rather than construct a stand-alone Olympic city.

A necessary distinction

The £50bn figure is the proposed size of the combined Games, infrastructure and urban-regeneration programme in illustrative 2026 prices. It is not a forecast of Olympic operating cost and it is not a claim that the development rights themselves are worth £50bn. Those figures require independent appraisal.

Why now

In May 2026, the Government announced an initial strategic assessment of whether the UK could host the Olympic and Paralympic Games in the North of England during the 2040s. The announcement expressly said that no bid had been committed to at that stage. This proposal is designed as an investable option to test alongside that official work—not as a substitute for it. [1]

Decision sought: agree to a structured, non-exclusive feasibility and investor-dialogue phase, with no award of development rights until a compliant procurement, valuation, planning and public-interest process has been completed.

02 / STRATEGIC CASE

Make the legacy the business plan

A Northern Games should be conceived as a programme of long-lived public assets and productive places—not a two-week event surrounded by underused venues. The International Olympic Committee expects host proposals to align with long-term development plans and demonstrate a credible funding strategy, political and public support, transport and accommodation capacity, sustainability and legacy. [2]

Strategic objectives

OBJECTIVE	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
A stronger northern gateway	A Manchester-led regional offer, with events distributed across suitable existing or planned venues and transport-linked centres where feasible.
Old Trafford as a regeneration anchor	Combine stadium and major-event activity with homes, jobs, public spaces, hotels, culture, local retail and improved access.
Transport that remains useful	Prioritise rail, tram, interchange capacity, step-free routes, walking and cycling. Use the Greater Manchester Transport Strategy 2040 as a starting point, not a blank sheet. [3]
Permanent participation legacy	Expand affordable community sport, accessible facilities, coaching, youth pathways and school partnerships across the region.
A stronger delivery model	One integrated programme office, transparent milestones, independent cost assurance and clear separation between public assets and commercial property.

Build on real precedent

Manchester staged the Commonwealth Games in 2002, providing local institutional experience of a major multi-sport event. [4] London 2012 also demonstrates the importance of converting event infrastructure into durable use: the Olympic Delivery Authority reports that the Olympic and Paralympic Village was transformed into more than 2,800 homes. [5] The lesson is not that Manchester should copy London; it is that every venue, parcel and public investment should have an accountable post-Games use before procurement begins.

> **Design rule**
>
> No permanent Olympic venue proceeds without a funded legacy operator, a credible post-Games utilisation plan and a whole-life cost model. Temporary facilities should be the default where there is no robust long-term need.

A regional footprint

The working concept is “Manchester-led, North-wide where it adds value”. The host geography should be settled only after venue audits, travel-time modelling, accommodation analysis, environmental review and consultation with potential host authorities. Any satellite venue must demonstrate that it improves the bid or reduces whole-life cost without shifting unreasonable burdens onto local residents.

03 / CAPITAL & FUNDING

A £50bn envelope, deployed in stages

All numbers below are an illustrative programme architecture, not an independently verified cost estimate or an approved budget. Values are stated in 2026 prices for comparison. A cost plan must later account for delivery-year inflation, financing, taxes, lifecycle maintenance and risk.

PROGRAMME ENVELOPE	£bn	ILLUSTRATIVE SCOPE
Games venues and delivery readiness	9	Temporary/permanent venues, village fit-out, event operations, ceremonies, broadcast, security and test events. The eventual Games budget must be separately costed.
Transport and regional mobility	12	Rail, tram, station/interchange capacity, bus integration, accessible routes, active travel and spectator movement.
Old Trafford district regeneration	15	Phased homes, commercial space, hotels, culture, retail, public squares and stadium-district infrastructure.
Homes, community and sport legacy	5	Affordable and mixed-tenure housing, community sports facilities, skills and local participation programmes.
Utilities, energy and resilience	4	Power, water, digital connectivity, heat networks where viable, flood resilience and climate adaptation.
Risk, contingency and programme reserve	5	A controlled reserve for quantified risks, scope changes and price uncertainty; releases require independent approval.
TOTAL ILLUSTRATIVE PROGRAMME	50	Not all components are expected to be spent by the Games opening; the regeneration programme continues after 2040.

Indicative matched funding principle

PROPOSED CONTRIBUTOR	ENVELOPE	FUNDING DISCIPLINE
UK Government / public-side partners	£25bn	A cap on the total public-side envelope, staged and subject to formal approval. May include eligible direct capital expenditure and approved infrastructure contributions. Any public guarantees or other risk-bearing support must be transparently valued; land is counted only if independently valued and actually contributed.
BTCPhilosopher Holdings / private-side partners	£25bn	Committed private capital for bankable regeneration assets, plus any event or infrastructure investment allocated by the agreed funding plan. Co-investment counts only when binding and funded; expected sales and uncommitted refinancing do not count as cash.

Public finance safeguard

The public-side £25bn is a negotiating ceiling, not an automatic appropriation or a blank cheque. Funding should be released by project gateway and only after the business case demonstrates affordability, additionality, value for money and an acceptable distribution of risk. No liability may be hidden off balance sheet or counted twice.

Commercial logic

Public money should pay for public goods and strategic infrastructure where the business case justifies it. Private capital should primarily fund assets with a credible commercial return. The funding plan should include transparent revenue forecasts, debt-service stress tests, downside scenarios, and a method for sharing material land-value uplift with the public where that uplift is enabled by public investment or planning decisions.

04 / OLD TRAFFORD DEVELOPMENT AGREEMENT

Rights in return for delivery—not a land giveaway

The commercial centrepiece would be an independently valued, competitively awarded master-development concession for a precisely mapped Old Trafford regeneration zone. The concession would give BTCPhilosopher Holdings a route to earn development returns, but only in parcels and phases where title, consent, infrastructure and delivery obligations are secured.

Proposed deal mechanics

TERM	PROPOSED PRINCIPLE
Scope	A schedule of land parcels, leaseholds and development opportunities agreed with the relevant landowners and public authorities. It is not a blanket right over Manchester or the whole of Trafford.
Term	A long-dated, phased concession, with review points and extension only on performance. Term to be fixed by independent financial and legal advice.
Consideration	BTCPhilosopher's binding private-capital commitment, agreed development milestones, any competitive premium or ground rent, and specified community-benefit obligations.
Planning	No guaranteed planning permission. Planning decisions remain with the legally competent authorities, independent of the commercial concession.
Land assembly	No land is assumed to be available or unencumbered. Club, private owner, public landowner, leaseholder, lender and statutory rights must be mapped and negotiated.
Default and step-in	Missed milestones, insolvency, misrepresentation or failure to fund trigger cure periods, security enforcement, step-in and/or termination rights. Undelivered parcels may be re-tendered.
Value sharing	Independent baseline valuation and overage/value-capture mechanism to return a negotiated share of above-baseline uplift to public and community purposes.

Why Old Trafford—and what must be respected

Manchester United has publicly confirmed an ambition for a 100,000-seat stadium and a wider Old Trafford regeneration district; its public materials also describe ongoing feasibility work and consultation. [6] This proposal therefore treats the district as an existing strategic project with its own landowners, supporters, neighbours and planning process—not an unclaimed development site.

- Separate the football club's stadium strategy and property rights from Olympic venue decisions. Any shared use must be negotiated with the club and venue operator.
- Do not assume the football stadium is suitable for Olympic athletics. Venue allocation must follow technical audits, sport requirements, broadcast needs and legacy economics.
- Protect homes, local businesses, heritage, public access, existing tenants and the right of residents to participate meaningfully in planning.

Contractual trigger

No exclusivity or development concession should be granted merely in exchange for a headline £25bn promise. Any award follows an open, legally compliant process and becomes effective only when financing, title, valuation, planning pathway and measurable public-benefit conditions are secured.

05 / THE PLACE

Old Trafford: a district with a life beyond 2040

The masterplan should connect an event district to ordinary urban life: housing, work, education, recreation, public transport and the river landscape. The objective is not a gated Olympic enclave, but a legible extension of the city with active streets and public assets that remain useful year-round.

DISTRICT	LONG-TERM FUNCTION
01 Stadium & major-event quarter	Football and event venues, training and sports medicine, fan spaces, broadcast/media uses and flexible indoor facilities. Venue roles remain subject to technical feasibility.
02 Homes & neighbourhood centre	Mixed-tenure housing; a defined affordable-housing commitment; schools/early-years provision where required; health and community services; everyday shops.
03 Transport interchange	Rail/tram/bus interchange improvements subject to appraisal; safe pedestrian and cycle routes; accessible wayfinding; event-day crowd management designed into normal-day operations.
04 River, park & climate corridor	Public green space, biodiversity, walking/cycling routes, sustainable drainage, flood-resilient landscape and a connected open-space network.
05 Commercial & cultural streets	Workspace, hotels, food and beverage, cultural uses and local retail. Phasing is tied to demonstrated demand, not speculative density alone.

Olympic village and venues

A village-led housing strategy should be tested alongside other accommodation options. New accommodation should have a defined post-Games use—preferably permanent homes where viable—rather than rely on a future conversion that has not been designed, costed or consented. The regional venue plan should audit existing arenas, stadia, pools, tracks and indoor halls before any new build is approved.

Housing and community commitments for negotiation

- Set an explicit affordable-housing target after viability and local-needs analysis; publish the tenure mix and delivery timetable.
- Use local labour and supplier targets where lawful, with apprenticeships and routes into construction, engineering, event operations and digital services.
- Provide protected public access to parks and principal walking/cycling routes; avoid making essential public space conditional on event tickets.
- Publish displacement, rent, small-business and community-impact assessments; agree mitigation and compensation before major works.
- Apply net-zero and whole-life carbon tests, circular construction, retrofit/reuse first and an independently verified climate-risk plan.

A measurable legacy contract

The development agreement should attach public KPIs to housing delivery, affordability, local employment, local procurement, public-space access, transport mode share, community-sport participation and operational carbon. Reporting should be annual, independently assured and linked to payments and concession rights.

06 / GOVERNANCE & RISK

Separate the public mission from the commercial return

A partnership at this scale should be governed as a public programme with a commercial development arm—not as a single opaque company. Clear separation protects taxpayers, investors, residents, landowners and the integrity of the Olympic bid process.

Proposed structure

BODY	MANDATE & CONTROLS
Strategic Partnership Board	UK Government/officials, Greater Manchester and local authorities, BTCPhilosopher Holdings, independent finance/cost/legacy members; public minutes and conflict declarations.
Games Delivery body	Responsible for bid coordination and Games delivery within agreed scope, with oversight from the appropriate national sporting and government bodies. Its budget is ring-fenced.
Old Trafford Development Co.	A ring-fenced development vehicle for defined parcels, asset-level financing, construction, leasing and sales. No automatic cross-subsidy from protected public-service budgets.
Independent assurance	Cost consultant, technical adviser, land valuer, auditor, environmental assessor and benefits evaluator procured independently. An independent chair for the audit/risk committee.
Community & legacy panel	Residents, supporters, local businesses, youth and disability/sport representatives; published responses to recommendations and a formal route to escalate concerns.

Risk allocation principles

RISK	PROPOSED MITIGATION
Games not awarded / bid fails	Do not start Games-only construction until gateway approval; preserve standalone value of transport and regeneration assets. Terminate or resize event-specific scope.
Cost escalation / delay	Independent reference-class estimates, quantified risk analysis, contingency held centrally, open-book cost reporting and contractual pain/gain sharing.
Land and planning	No assumption of consent; secure title and consents parcel by parcel. Development concession confers no planning advantage.
Demand and sales values	Downside stress tests, phased release, minimum financing tests, no reliance on uncontracted sales as committed capital.
Taxpayer exposure	Hard public cap, transparent guarantees, parliamentary/statutory approvals, regular fiscal reporting and pre-agreed termination liabilities.
Digital assets / Bitcoin-related exposure	Programme budget and public obligations denominated in GBP. Any digital-asset financing is optional, legally reviewed, fully disclosed, ring-fenced and not a condition for public support.
Community and environment	Early consultation, accessible design, impact mitigation, carbon/flood tests, local benefit obligations, independent complaints and remedy process.

Public accountability is a condition precedent: disclose key contracts, beneficial ownership, related-party dealings, senior pay, lobbying, procurement decisions, risk registers and delivery performance, subject to lawful commercial confidentiality and security exemptions.

07 / DELIVERY ROADMAP

A gated route from concept to delivery

The schedule below is indicative and must be reconciled with the official UK Olympic feasibility and host-selection timetable. It is not a prediction of when the International Olympic Committee will select a host. The programme should remain useful if the Games are not awarded.

PERIOD	GATE	DELIVERABLES
2026–2027	Feasibility and investor dialogue	Confirm objectives, governance, baseline costs, venue inventory, transport capacity, land map, consultation plan, legal structure and independent assessment of the £50bn envelope.
2027–2029	Strategic option and bid decision gates	Compare options; establish whether the bid is viable; secure stakeholder and public support; select a regional footprint; draft a funding and legacy plan. Timing subject to national/IOC processes.
2029–2032	Business cases and land agreements	Complete outline/full business cases, land valuations, environmental assessment, planning strategy, procurement, asset-level finance and concession documents.
2032–2036	Core infrastructure and first phases	Deliver enabling transport, utilities, public realm and early housing/commercial parcels where approvals and funding are secured.
2035–2038	Venue delivery and village conversion works	Build or refurbish approved venues, test village legacy conversion, commission systems, recruit operators and prepare community programmes. Overlap subject to design maturity.
2038–2039	Test events and readiness	Run operational tests, accessibility audits, security exercises, transport rehearsals, venue certification and independent readiness reviews.
2040	Games year — only if awarded	Operate the Games under the approved Games Delivery structure; protect non-event city services and monitor transport, housing and public-realm performance.
2040 onward	Legacy and concession delivery	Convert temporary uses, complete long-term homes and commercial phases, maintain public assets, report outcomes and share agreed value uplift.

Gate conditions before material spend

- Gate 1 — strategic case: a credible regional venue plan, transport approach, public support and a realistic route through the national and IOC processes.
- Gate 2 — commercial and fiscal case: independently assured cost plan, proven sources of finance, risk-adjusted public exposure and sensitivity analysis.
- Gate 3 — land and planning: validated title schedule, landowner agreements, statutory approvals pathway, environmental review and consultation.
- Gate 4 — delivery readiness: signed funding, operator agreements, procurement, construction strategy, legacy conversion plan and contingency.

Stop/go discipline

Projects that fail a gate are redesigned, deferred or stopped. A Games bid should not be used to bypass planning, appraisal, procurement or public consultation.

08 / PROPOSED HEADS OF TERMS

What the parties would agree to test

The following is a basis for a non-binding memorandum of understanding and feasibility phase. It is not an offer capable of acceptance and creates no obligation to fund, award rights, submit a bid or transfer property.

TERM	DRAFT POSITION
Parties	UK Government and BTCPhilosopher Holdings, with Greater Manchester, Trafford, Manchester, national sporting bodies, venue owners and other authorities involved under separate agreements as appropriate.
Purpose	Assess a Manchester-led Olympic and Paralympic proposition for 2040 and a linked long-term regeneration programme centred on Old Trafford.
Indicative envelope	£50bn total programme in illustrative 2026 prices, with a target 50:50 public/private contribution architecture of £25bn each, subject to evidence and approval.
No commitment	Headline figures are planning assumptions. No funds are appropriated; no guarantee is issued; no exclusivity or land right is created by the MOU.
Private obligation	BTCPhilosopher Holdings provides evidence of funding capacity, source of funds, beneficial ownership, financial statements, investment mandate and binding evidence at each gateway.
Public obligation	Public bodies facilitate lawful feasibility, data-sharing and stakeholder coordination; any funding support remains subject to statutory authority, business-case approval and affordability.
Development rights	Any Old Trafford concession is separately valued and awarded through an appropriate transparent process. Terms include milestones, public benefits, rent/premium, value sharing, default and step-in rights.
Governance	Joint steering group, independent cost adviser, published risk register, conflicts register, quarterly progress report and resident/supporter engagement.
Conditions precedent	Feasibility, value for money, funding certainty, legal/procurement opinions, landowner consent, planning pathway, environmental approval, public consultation and national sporting/government decisions.
Exit / sunset	Either party can exit the feasibility phase on notice. MOU expires after an agreed period unless extended in writing. Confidentiality and lawful data-retention provisions survive where needed.

Immediate decisions requested

- Invite BTCPhilosopher Holdings to a structured, non-exclusive investor dialogue alongside other potential delivery partners.
- Commission an independent scoping paper covering cost, venue reuse, transport, land assembly, environmental impact, demand and fiscal exposure.
- Establish a joint data room and stakeholder map, including Old Trafford landowners, the football club, local authorities, transport bodies, resident groups and national sporting authorities.
- Agree a short-form MOU that explicitly preserves public procurement, planning, funding and host-selection decisions.

Recommended next document

A jointly commissioned Strategic Feasibility Brief, followed—only if approved—by an Outline Business Case and a separate, competitively procured Old Trafford development opportunity.

09 / SOURCES & ASSUMPTIONS

Evidence base and status of this document

This document is a proposed commercial concept prepared on 25 October 2026. It combines verified public context with a hypothetical financing and delivery structure for discussion. It is not an official Government, Greater Manchester, Manchester United, UK Sport, British Olympic Association, British Paralympic Association or IOC document.

Public sources

[1] Department for Culture, Media and Sport / GOV.UK, “First Olympics in the North of England in government’s sights alongside stadium regeneration push”, 17 May 2026. The announcement describes an initial strategic assessment and says that the Government was not committing to a bid at that stage.
https://www.gov.uk/government/news/first-olympics-in-the-north-of-england-in-governments-sights-alongside-stadium-regeneration-push

[2] International Olympic Committee, “Requirements to host the Olympic Games”. Relevant factors include sustainability and legacy, alignment with long-term plans, political/public support, funding strategy, transport, accommodation and safety/security.
https://www.olympics.com/ioc/becoming-an-olympic-games-host/requirements-to-host-the-olympic-games

[3] Greater Manchester Combined Authority / Transport for Greater Manchester, “The Greater Manchester Transport Strategy 2040”. Used as a strategic starting point for regional connectivity and mobility alignment.
https://www.greatermanchester-ca.gov.uk/what-we-do/environment/transport-and-travel/

[4] Manchester City Council, “Commonwealth Games 2002”. Used as evidence of Manchester’s experience hosting a major multi-sport event.
https://www.manchester.gov.uk/online-directories/libraries-directories/archives-and-local-history-directories/archive-and-local-collections/view-all-collections/commonwealth-games-2002

[5] UK Government, “Olympic Delivery Authority: About us”. Reports that the Olympic and Paralympic Village was transformed into more than 2,800 homes after London 2012.
https://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/olympic-delivery-authority/about

[6] Manchester United, “Old Trafford Regeneration”. Sets out the club’s stated ambition for a 100,000-seat stadium and describes feasibility, masterplanning and consultation work.
https://www.manutd.com/en/stadium

Core assumptions requiring verification

- The Games year is treated as a target scenario only. Manchester has not been designated host of the 2040 Olympic and Paralympic Games by this proposal.
- The £50bn programme envelope, allocations, £25bn / £25bn split, concession structure, housing concept and delivery schedule are illustrative assumptions prepared for debate. They require independent cost, economic, financial, legal, planning and environmental analysis.
- No conclusion is made about the value, ownership, availability or developability of any Old Trafford land or about any party’s willingness to transact.
- All public expenditure, guarantees, procurement, land transactions, planning decisions, sports rights and host decisions remain subject to applicable law and the competent institutions.
- No investment return is guaranteed. BTCPhilosopher Holdings’ funding capacity, ownership, governance, source of funds and suitability must be independently verified before any formal process.

Prepared by: BTCPhilosopher Holdings — concept proposal. This document is for preliminary discussion only and should be reviewed by UK public-finance, procurement, planning, property, tax, construction and Olympic-delivery advisers before external reliance.